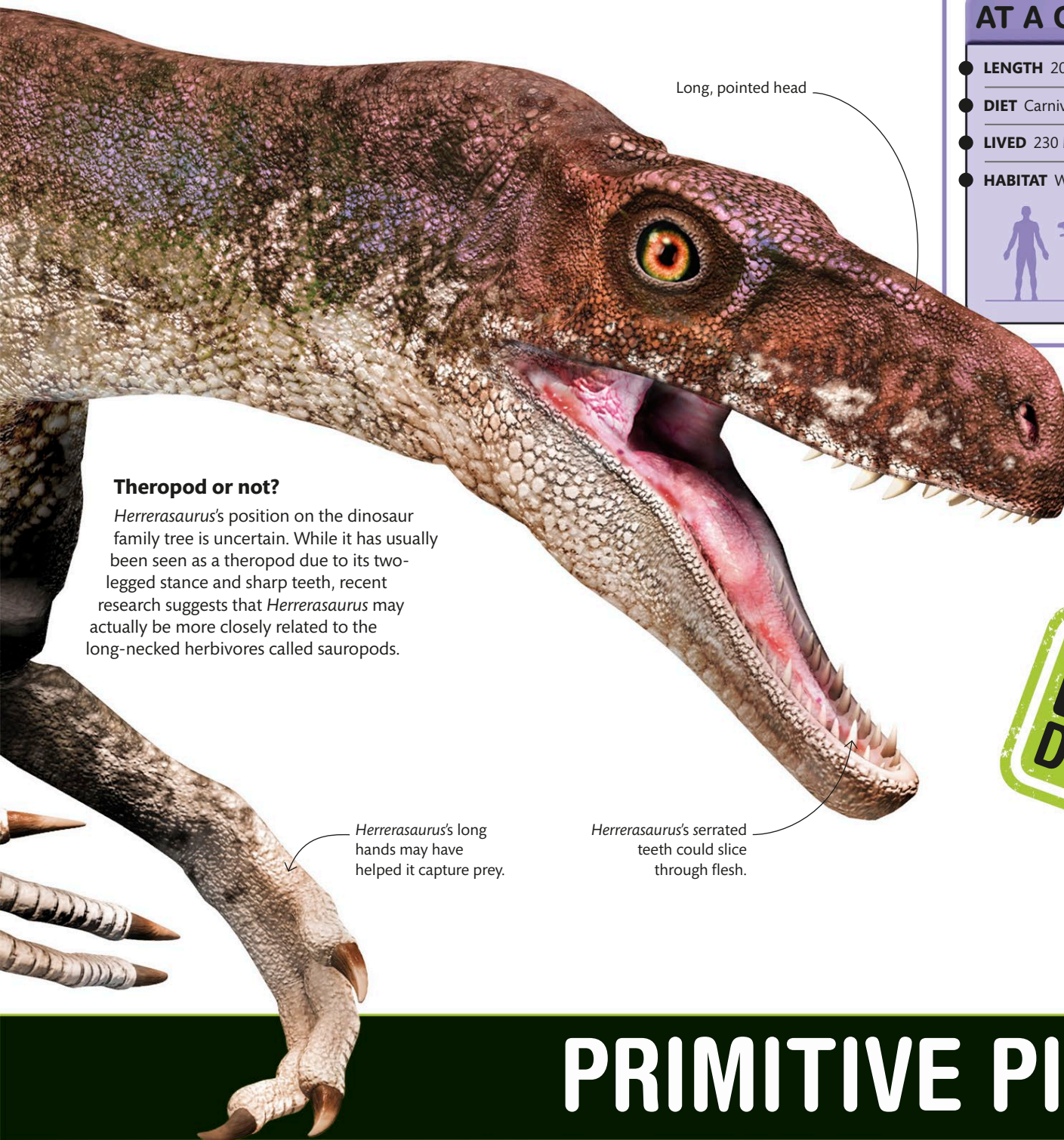




Long, pointed head

AT A GLANCE

● **LENGTH** 20 ft (6 m)

● **DIET** Carnivore

● **LIVED** 230 MYA

● **HABITAT** Woodlands



Theropod or not?

Herrerasaurus's position on the dinosaur family tree is uncertain. While it has usually been seen as a theropod due to its two-legged stance and sharp teeth, recent research suggests that *Herrerasaurus* may actually be more closely related to the long-necked herbivores called sauropods.

Herrerasaurus's long hands may have helped it capture prey.

Herrerasaurus's serrated teeth could slice through flesh.



PRIMITIVE PIONEER

HERRERASAURUS

One of the earliest dinosaurs to evolve, *Herrerasaurus* lived in the Late Triassic Period. It was probably a nimble carnivore that preyed on small prehistoric reptiles, mammals, or other early dinosaurs, and it had many features that would have made it a dangerous predator. Skull fossils show it had thin, serrated teeth and an unusually flexible lower jaw, which may have given it extra grip on struggling animals. *Herrerasaurus*'s long, sturdy tail allowed it to balance its weight over its hind legs, which may have helped it chase down unlucky prey.